

TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES · #12

# Hiring with AI

Write a job ad that attracts the right people, screen applicants in minutes instead of evenings, and interview like a company ten times your size.

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## WHO IT'S FOR

Owners who need to hire but dread the resume pile and the gut-feel gamble

## TIME REQUIRED

15 minutes

## WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

A complete hiring kit — job ad, screening rubric, interview questions — drafted today

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# Bad hires don't come from bad luck. They come from vague job ads and gut-feel interviews.

This playbook uses AI to sharpen every stage: a job ad that defines success, a rubric that scores applicants the same way every time, and interview questions that predict performance — not charm.

*A wrong hire costs months of wages plus the damage they leave behind — for a small business, that's a brutal bill. The fix isn't hiring slower. It's deciding what "great" looks like BEFORE you meet anyone, and letting AI do the paperwork while you do the judging. Humans make the call. AI just makes sure it's an informed one.*

— Ray, TsangAI Consulting

## WHY THIS MATTERS

### 6+ mo

What a wrong hire typically costs when you count wages, time, and cleanup

### 15 min

Time to draft your full hiring kit with the prompts in this guide

### Same bar

A scoring rubric judges applicant #40 as fairly as applicant #1

## THE ONE IDEA

### Define the outcome. Screen with a rubric. Decide with your eyes open.

Most job ads list duties. Great ones define outcomes — what a win looks like at 90 days. When the target is clear, AI can write the ad, build the scorecard, and rank the pile. You spend your time only on the top five.

**Example:** An electrical contractor rewrote "electrician wanted, must be reliable" into an outcome-based ad with three 90-day wins. Applications doubled, and screening 43 resumes against the rubric took one evening coffee instead of a lost weekend.

## YOUR 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

- ☐ Write the three outcomes a great hire would deliver in 90 days
- ☐ Run the Job Ad Prompt on page 4 — read the draft it produces
- ☐ Ask AI to build the screening rubric from the same outcomes
- ☐ Save both — your next hire now starts from a system, not a blank page

## Five steps to a hire you're confident in

### 1 Define the 90-day win

Before any ad goes out: what three things would make you say "best hire I ever made" at day 90? Numbers where possible.

**Do this:** Write the three outcomes. Example: "Runs jobs solo by week 6."

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### 2 Let AI write the job ad

Feed it your outcomes and your company's personality. You'll get an ad that talks about the candidate's future, not just your requirements list.

**Do this:** Run the Job Ad Prompt on page 4. Edit once for voice, then post it.

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### 3 Screen with the rubric, not your mood

Score every applicant against the same five criteria. Add one small instruction in the ad (like "start your note with the word BLUE") to instantly filter who actually reads.

**Do this:** Use the rubric on page 4. Only the top 5 scores get a call.

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### 4 Interview with structure

Same questions, same order, every candidate — behavioral questions about what they've done, not what they'd hypothetically do. Score answers 1–5 as you go.

**Do this:** Generate your question set with the Interview Kit Prompt on page 4. Print it, score on paper.

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### 5 Onboard like you mean it

The hire isn't done at "yes." Week one decides whether they stay two years or two months. Reuse guide #09's onboarding structure — it works for employees too.

**Do this:** Ask AI for a 30-day onboarding plan from your three outcomes. Book the day-7 and day-30 check-ins now.

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#### COMMON MISTAKES

### This is where most business owners get stuck.

They write the ad about their needs instead of the candidate's future. They hire the best interviewer instead of the best worker — structure beats charm. And they let AI make the final call; it screens, you decide.

#### PRO TIP

Keep every scored rubric, even from candidates you rejected. Next opening, you have a warm bench of silver medalists — and your fastest, cheapest hire is often someone you already ranked #2 six months ago.

# Your hiring kit — ad, rubric, and interview prompts

## The Job Ad Prompt

You are a recruiting copywriter for small service businesses. My business: [WHAT YOU DO] in [AREA], team of [N]. I'm hiring a [ROLE]. A great hire delivers these in 90 days: [OUTCOME 1], [OUTCOME 2], [OUTCOME 3]. Pay: [RANGE]. Write a job ad that: 1) opens with what's in it for them, 2) describes a real week in the role, 3) lists must-haves (max 5) and nice-to-haves, 4) ends with how to apply, including this instruction: "Start your application with the word [CODEWORD]." Friendly, plain language, no corporate clichés.

## The Screening Rubric score 1–5 each

| CRITERIA                                   | SCORE      |
|--------------------------------------------|------------|
| Followed the codeword instruction          | —          |
| Evidence they've done this work before     | —          |
| Signs of reliability (tenure, references)  | —          |
| Communication quality in their application | —          |
| Fit with the 90-day outcomes               | —          |
| <b>Total (call top 5 scores)</b>           | <b>/25</b> |

## The Interview Kit Prompt

Build a structured interview kit for a [ROLE] at my [WHAT YOU DO] business. The 90-day outcomes: [PASTE THEM]. Give me: 1) 6 behavioral questions ("tell me about a time...") tied to those outcomes, 2) what a 5/5 answer sounds like for each, 3) 2 red flags to listen for, 4) a simple scoring sheet I can print. Keep the language plain.

### FAIR PLAY NOTE

Use AI to organize and score against job-related criteria you define — never to guess age, background, or anything personal. Better decisions, cleaner process, zero shortcuts on fairness.

## Turn this guide into one win this week.

A guide you read changes nothing. A page you fill in does. Two minutes — do it while it's fresh.

### 1 • WHERE I AM TODAY

The role I'm hiring: \_\_\_\_\_

My 3 outcomes written? ☐

### 2 • THE ONE THING I'M FIXING THIS WEEK

My one fix: \_\_\_\_\_

The first small step (under 15 minutes): \_\_\_\_\_

Small beats big. Pick something you can finish in one sitting.

### 3 • WHEN I'M DOING IT

Day: \_\_\_\_\_ Time: \_\_\_\_\_ Booked in my calendar? ☐

Open your calendar and book it now — a plan without a time slot is a wish.

### 4 • AFTER — WHAT HAPPENED

My result (hours saved, jobs booked, thing shipped): \_\_\_\_\_

What I'll do differently next time: \_\_\_\_\_

### NOTES

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### KEEP THE STREAK

One fix a week is 52 upgrades a year. When this page is full, re-take the guide — a rising score is proof your systems are working.